1.0 INTRODUCTION

SPQR—the acronym for Senatus Populusque Romanus, the Senate and the Roman People, the (supposed) power behind the state— portrays the development of the art of war from the end of the Macedonian era through the heyday of the Republic of Rome, prior to the changes in the army (supposedly) wrought by Marius and the collapse of the republic.

SPQR is the second volume in the *Great Battles of History Series*. It chronicles and simulates the emergence of the Roman military system and its clashes with—and eventual victories over—the Macedonian system. Whereas the Macedonian system relied on an effective use of combined arms anchored by the strength of the Phalanx and spearheaded by the shock ability of heavy cavalry, the Roman "manipular" legion placed a premium on training and discipline to produce a remarkable tactical flexibility, backed by the defensive ability of the Roman scutum to neutralize the spear and the added killing ability of the infamous Roman sword. However, in terms of "military history" and the art of war, Rome remained a minor, albeit dangerous, military power until the emergence of her first great military mind: Scipio Africanus. Scipio was the first commander to make maximum use of the articulated capabilities of the legion, to understand the importance of cavalry superiority and, most importantly, to break out of the stagnant, break-the-enemy-center tactical thinking of the prior two centuries.

SPQR includes many historical notes so that you can see what questions of military history arose from the individual battles, as well as the usual section on terminology, all so that you can understand more fully where we are going—and where it all came from. Finally, there are indications of how long and how well-balanced (in terms of having a chance to win) the battles are —all based on playtester experience and input. Your experiences, to be sure, may vary.

5th Edition Note: These rules supersede and replace those of the prior editions. Significant changes from the 4th Edition rules are noted with a Design/Play Note. The rules and scenarios have undergone a comprehensive edit incorporating all known errata and clarifications. In addition, the wording of several rules common to all games in the series has been updated to match the recent *GBoH* publications.

Note to Players: *SPQR*, while not an overly difficult game to learn, understand, or play, uses a tactical system which most rewards those who know what their men can do and how to exploit the capabilities of even the worst of them. As warfare evolved from the previous Alexandrian era and became infinitely more complex, the rules reflect, albeit only slightly, that increased complexity. To calmly blunder into battle with a "let's see what happens here" theory is to be exiled quickly to some forlorn rock in the Mediterranean.

For Those Who Have Not Played the System Before: Even if you are quite familiar with simulation gaming, we suggest that you either use the "Learning Scenario" or, if you are anxious to start slashing and thrusting in a historical manner, set up a battle (we recommend "The Bagradas Plains" for this purpose) and push the counters around for a turn or two before actually starting a game. This will reveal the various tactical strategies available, how the different types of weapons systems may best be used and how best to (try to) protect against them. The one thing to remember is that the more you know about your units and how they act/interact, the better commander you will be.

2.0 GAME COMPONENTS AND TERMINOLOGY

The *SPQR* components include:

- Six 22" x 34" map sheets, backprinted
- Six counters sheets (1/2", 280 counters per full sheet)
- Rulebook
- Scenario Book I - The Rise of Rome
- Scenario Book II - The 2nd Punic War
- Scenario Book III - Macedonia, Syria, and Africa
- Four 11" x 17" player aid cards, PAC I and PAC II, two-sided, two identical copies of each
- One 8 ½" x 11" Rout Point Tracking/Game Turn Card
- One ten-sided die
- Plastic counter storage bags

2.1 THE MAPS

Each battle is played on a 22" x 34" map, with each map backprinted so that there are two battlefields per map sheet. A hex grid covers each map to regulate movement and combat, and the effects of the different types of terrain on the map are covered in the rules and charts.

2.2 THE PLAYING PIECES

There are three types of playing pieces (counters): combat units, representing the various types of fighting troops; leaders, the individuals who command the troops; and information markers, used to note certain types of information necessary for play.

2.21 Combat units come in two sizes: square and rectangular, the latter representing the rigid, Macedonian-style Phalanx formation still used by some heavy infantry. Each combat unit is a specific type (as illustrated below), depending on its weaponry and body armor/protection. All combat units are rated numerically for their Size, Troop Quality (TQ), and Movement capability. Units that are capable of firing missiles also have a Missile Indicator, indicating the class of missiles used (A = arrow, J = javelin and S = stone). The Missile Table gives the Ranges available for these missiles. Each combat unit has two sides. When a unit is flipped to its reverse side, that side indicates that it is Depleted (10.3).

2.22 Each unit is of a specific Type (e.g., HI, LC, etc.), the type being used to determine certain combat results and effectiveness with respect to other types. Many types are subdivided into Class: e.g., HO Class, HI Type (Hoplite-style Heavy infantry); or HA Class, LG Type (Hastati legionaries).

2.23 The Legions. We have provided eight full Roman legions with the game, together with their corresponding alae sociorum, each with a numerical designation. These designations are not

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